Yorktown 1781: publishing guide

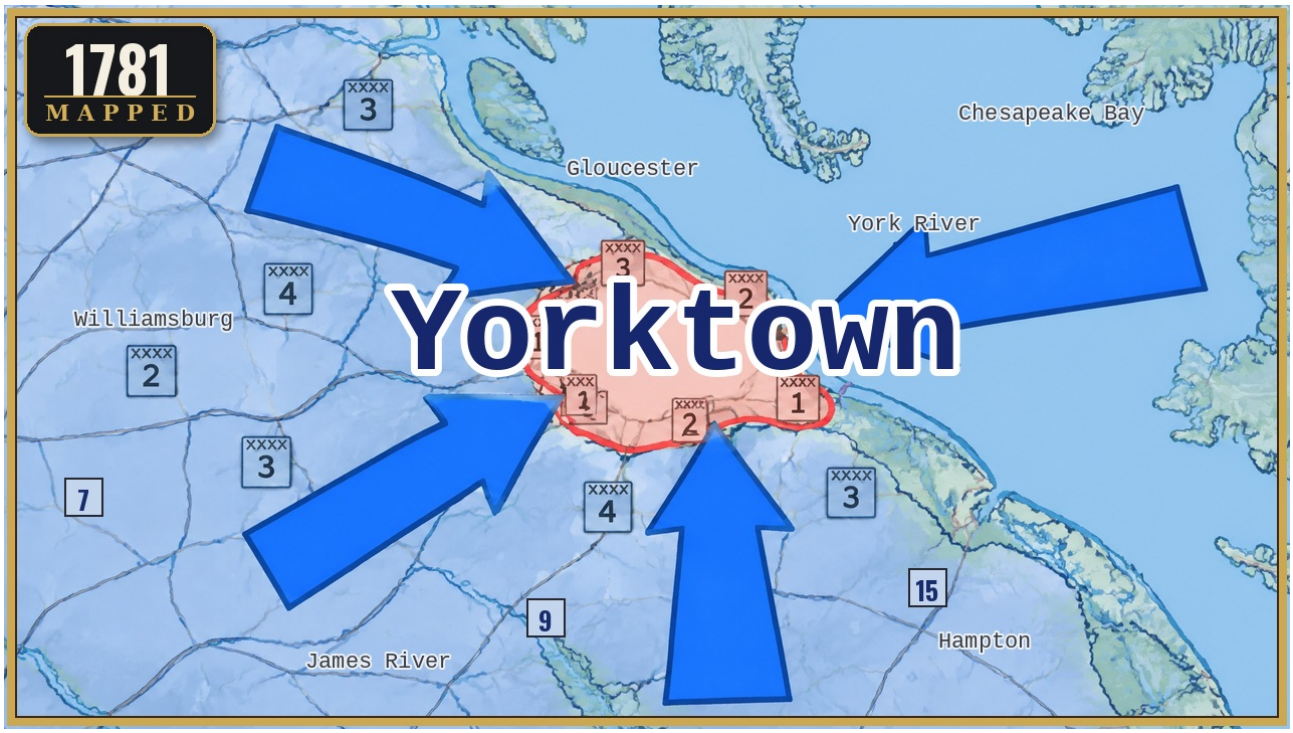
Item	Details
File	build/yorktown_final.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC; -14.2 LUFS, true peak -1.4 dB)
Download	https://gofile.io/d/roGkUWAa (Yorktown-1781-1080p.mp4, md5 36ae371524c46487b28676a9d7a3ca65)
Length	16:02
Voice	owner clone (Chatterbox VC, ref tts/voices/owner_clone_test.mp3)
Format	single-battle story (first of the channel)

Titles (PACKAGING_GUIDE 0b; owner picks the main one, the others go into Test & Compare)

	Title	vidIQ	Claim check (FACT_NOTES)
A	Britain Thought Yorktown Was a Safe Harbor. Washington Turned It Into a Trap	93	Clinton/Cornwallis chose Yorktown as a naval station that relied on sea control; allied trap; surrender 19 Oct 1781
B	The Battle of Yorktown: How Washington Trapped Cornwallis's Army	91	Over 7,000 surrendered (7,073-7,247)
C	The Secret March and the Sea Battle That Trapped Cornwallis at Yorktown	93	Deception march Aug-Sep 1781 (Washington's diary 18 Aug); Battle of the Capes 5 Sep

Avoided: 'ended the war' (Treaty of Paris 1783), '450 miles' (sources: over 400 from the Hudson).

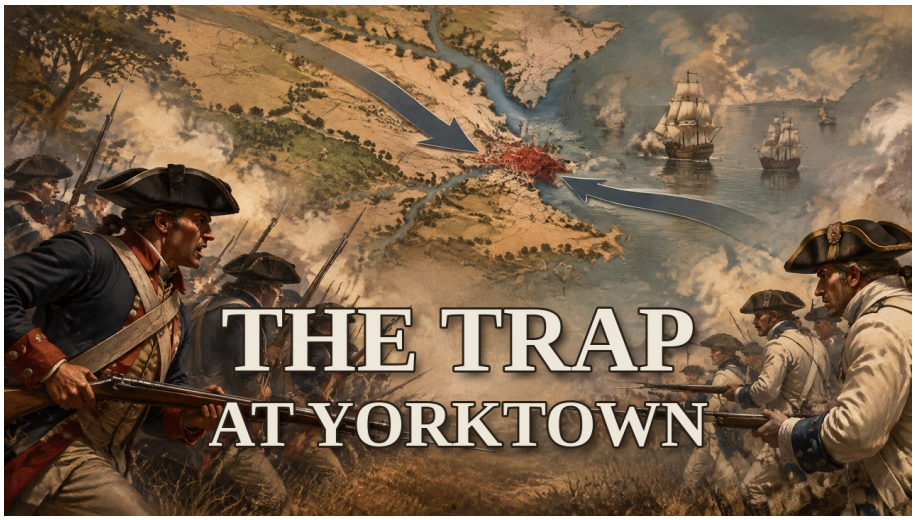
Thumbnails (owner's pick 2026-11-13; made with vidIQ from the channel's competitor study, research/competitors_top20/SUMMARY.md)



MAIN: D2 'Yorktown' map (Eastory pattern: map + ONE big place name + arrows; reference Eastory 'Eastern Front 1944/45', 10.3M). Pair with title A. The only map thumbnail in the Yorktown sidebar. Corner plate '1781 MAPPED' (our own, no logo).

Note: the small unit counters use a modern army symbol (XXXX); kept as the owner chose.

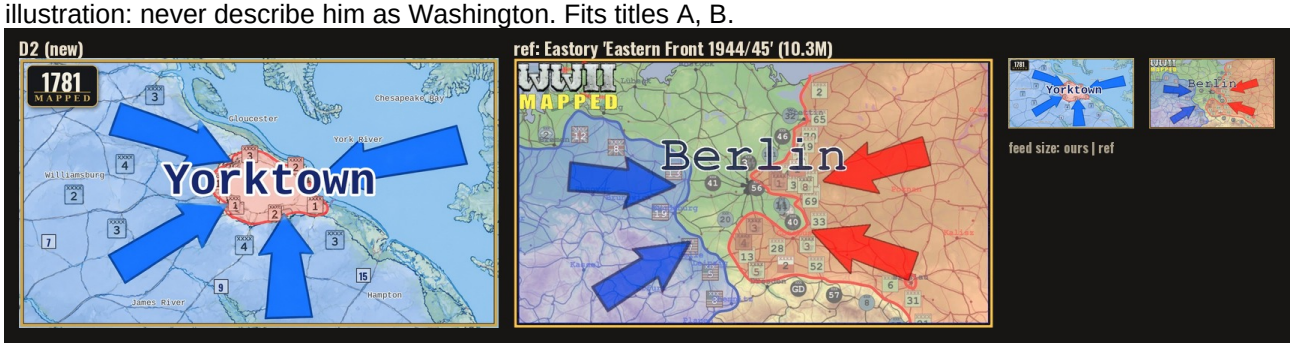
Test & Compare alternatives (optional)



E 'THE TRAP AT YORKTOWN' (Kings and Generals pattern: illustration over a faded map + caps headline). Fits titles A, B.



F2 'YORKTOWN · 1781 · THE TRAP' (Epic History pattern + arrows on the map). The rider is a generic AI illustration: never describe him as Washington. Fits titles A, B.



D2 next to its reference + feed-size check.

Description (no links)

In 1781 the American Revolution was broke, its army unpaid and close to mutiny. The British dug in at Yorktown, Virginia, sure that the Royal Navy would keep them safe. In three weeks, the safe harbor became a trap.

This is the story of Yorktown, told on animated painted maps: Washington and Rochambeau's march south that fooled the British in New York, the Battle of the Capes where de Grasse's French fleet shut the Chesapeake, and the siege, from the first trench dug in the rain to the night storming of Redoubts 9 and 10, Cornwallis's failed escape across the York River in a storm, and the surrender on 19 October 1781.

Which part won Yorktown: the march, the sea, or the siege? Tell us in the comments, and tell us which battle we should tell next.

CHAPTERS

0:00 Intro: The Safe Harbor

1:32 Part 1: The March (Aug-Sep 1781)

5:45 Part 2: The Battle of the Capes (5 Sep 1781)

8:57 Part 3: The Siege (28 Sep - 19 Oct 1781)

15:17 Legacy

SOURCES

Henry P. Johnston, The Yorktown Campaign and the Surrender of Cornwallis, 1781 (1881)

B. F. Stevens (ed.), The Campaign in Virginia 1781: The Clinton-Cornwallis Controversy (1888)

James Thacher, A Military Journal during the American Revolutionary War (1823/1827)

The Diaries and Writings of George Washington

Richard M. Ketchum, Victory at Yorktown (2004)

Harold A. Larrabee, Decision at the Chesapeake (1964)

National Park Service, Colonial National Historical Park (Yorktown Battlefield)

Notes: "The World Turned Upside Down" at the surrender is a legend first printed in 1828. The war ended with the Treaty of Paris in 1783.

MAPS

Animated maps made for this channel from open terrain data (Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles) and USGS National Hydrography data.

IMAGES

John Trumbull, Surrender of Lord Cornwallis (public domain). Portraits: Charles Willson Peale, Thomas Gainsborough, John Trumbull, Joshua Reynolds and others (public domain). Full list in the pinned comment.

MUSIC

"Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish" by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com), licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0.

SOUND EFFECTS

"artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots" by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), via freesound.org.

#Yorktown #AmericanRevolution #GeorgeWashington #MilitaryHistory #RevolutionaryWar

Tags

Yorktown, Battle of Yorktown, Siege of Yorktown, Yorktown 1781, George Washington, Cornwallis, Rochambeau, de Grasse, Battle of the Chesapeake, Battle of the Capes, American Revolution, Revolutionary War, Alexander Hamilton, Redoubt 10, military history, animated battle map

Settings

Setting	Value
Category	Education
Made for kids	No
Altered content	No (maps animated; no realistic AI people)
Captions	English auto-captions; check names (Rochambeau, de Grasse, Cornwallis, Barras, Lauzun, Gloucester, Tarleton)
Pinned comment	Which part won Yorktown: 1 the march, 2 the sea, or 3 the siege? And which battle should we tell next?
End screen	last ~20 s: the channel's busiest video (Morgan) + subscribe

Checklist

Test & Compare with the 3 thumbnails; log title/thumbnail winner, CTR and day 1-3 impressions per traffic source in research/CHANNEL_LOG.md (standard Studio prompt, DATA_RULES); retention at 0:30 and 1:00 logged separately.

Facts to double-check

Chester hat-and-handkerchief scene (single eyewitness, von Closen); Washington firing the first American gun (reported); Nelson house (tradition, told as such); Rochambeau step in the sword hand-over (reported); Lord North quote (Wraxall, 'is said to'). Barras has no known portrait (banner shows initials); de Grasse and Hood portraits could not be downloaded (Wikimedia throttling) and show initials. The Battle of the Capes painting's author/licence (Commons says PD, US Navy art) should be checked on its file page before upload.